

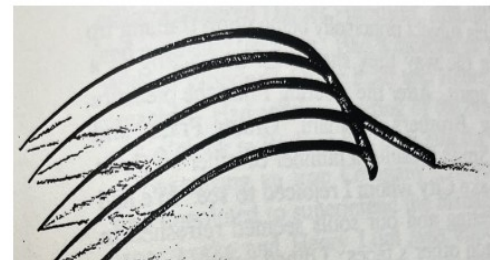


ELLEN WHITTAKER LUNT

June 6, 1830 – May 18, 1903

Born in Bolton, Lancashire, England

She was a weaver, by profession, the same as her father.



CHAPTER VI
IRON WORKS
1852

Manufacturing iron was the principle factor in determining the location of the settlements of Parowan and Cedar City. Before pursuing this object, however, it was necessary to take care of the physical needs of those who were to take part in this task. The L.D.S. Church was desirous of being independent of foreign countries, and even Eastern United States, for the iron they needed for machinery and domestic use. The time was right to proceed in this direction.

President Brigham Young and a group of some sixty brethren traveled from the Great Salt Lake Valley to Parowan, arriving Saturday, May 8, 1852.¹ Presiding Elder Carruthers received a note that day from President Groves of Parowan inviting as many of the brethren from Cedar City as could make it to come there on Sunday for the ensuing meetings. Henry Lunt wrote the following about what took place:

May 9, 1852: Myself, in company with Brothers Carruthers and Wood, started for Parowan ¼ past 9 a.m. in Brother Wood's carriage. Arrived at Parowan at 11 a.m. and attended a meeting in the new meeting house. Very large congregation. Brigham Young, Heber C. Kimball, Orson Pratt, Wilford Woodruff,

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General Wells and some sixty more brethren were there from the Salt Lake Valley. Orson Pratt preached, his subject principally being upon training up children in the way they should go and acting in a oneness of spirit. After the meeting I had the pleasure of greeting Brothers Brigham, Orson Pratt, and George A. Smith, besides a number of other brethren from Salt Lake City whom I rejoiced to see. We had a happy meeting and our souls seemed refreshed in beholding each other's faces. I dined sumptuously at John D. Lee's, together with Brigham Young, H. C. Kimball, Orson Pratt, Wilford Woodruff, George A. Smith, D. H. Wells, Bishop Groves, Brother Blair and some fifteen more brethren and sisters. Attended meeting again at two p.m. Brigham Young and Heber C. Kimball addressed the congregation in their noble and godlike manner. The saints rejoiced under their teachings. Returned to Cedar City in the evening. President Young and company promised to visit us at Cedar City in the morning.

Monday, May 10, 1852: Fine day. Brigham Young and company arrived at Cedar City about 3 p.m. with some thirty wagons. Our little city was all in excitement through so great a number of visitors. I had the following brethren and sisters who I invited and came to our house: George A. Smith, John L. Smith, Wilford Woodruff, Elisha H. Groves, W. A. Morse, P. Meeks, Seth M. Blair, Brother Farr and Sisters Groves and Banks. We enjoyed ourselves together. I called a meeting of all the brethren and sisters together in Brother Carruther's yard. We had a large meeting and were addressed by Brigham Young and George A. Smith. The principal subject was to make iron. Spent a very pleasant evening with our visitors. The delightful notes of the Brass Band cheered our hearts with its music.²

Tuesday, May 11: Delightful fine day. Mustered at 8 o'clock. I organized my company with all the officers required (James Furguson, Adjutant General) and inspected the arms. Had a meeting at 10 o'clock. Wilford Woodruff, Orson Pratt and Heber C. Kimball preached. Had another meeting of the brethren, only, at 4 o'clock in Brother Ross's house for the purpose of organizing an Iron Company. Richard Harrison was appointed to superintend the management of the iron works and Henry Lunt was appointed Clerk. Other brethren were appointed to manage the different departments. The Brass Band played considerable in the evening.

Wednesday, May 12: The morning fine. Brigham Young and company left for Parowan. I went with them, riding in Brother Brigham's wagon. Rather showery on our way. Arrived at Parowan about one o'clock. I dined with Bishop Robinson. Meeting in the Council House at 4 o'clock. Parowan and Cedar City were organized into one Stake of Zion [Iron County Stake], also, a presidency over the same--John Calvin L. Smith, President; John Steele from Parowan, First Counselor; and Henry Lunt from Cedar City, Second Counselor. The above named Presidency were ordained to their offices and also made High Priests.³

A High Council was also organized with former Presiding Elder, Matthew Carruthers, John D. Lee, and William H. Dame among the High Councilmen. The following was written in a biographical sketch about William H. Dame: "He was ordained a High Priest and placed in the first High Council of the Iron County Stake, being the eleventh member by age. Philip K. Smith was ordained Bishop for Cedar City. James Furguson read an Epistle from Brigham Young and Heber C. Kimball."⁴ After the meeting Henry Lunt stayed up until one a.m. making a copy of the Epistle by candlelight.⁵ The Iron County Stake was the fourth L.D.S. Stake to be organized in the Great Basin. The

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first stake was formed in Salt Lake City on February 1, 1849; the second was Weber Stake, organized January 26, 1851; and the third was Provo Stake, organized March 19, 1851.⁶

Excerpts from the Epistle written by Brigham Young and Heber C. Kimball are as follows:

Brethren, in your midst our hearts have been made to rejoice and our souls refreshed in the union of spirit and effort, the good order and industry which so eminently characterizes your exertions, and the love of which so richly abides in you.

It is with regret that we observe that there are some among you who seem disposed to scatter out from the forts, thereby hazarding their own lives and the peace of the whole territory. We are located in the midst of savage tribes who, for generations untold, have been taught to plunder and kill and the gratification of every lustful appetite for blood and revenge, success in which among themselves paves the way to distinction and influence. They are, moreover, ignorant and degraded, living in the lowest degree of filthiness, practicing extreme barbarity to all such as, unfortunately, fall into their hands. They are of Israel, so are we; our position among them furnishes abundant opportunities of doing good . . . it is a privilege as well as a duty, thus, to use our influence and exertion to bring them back to the fold of Christ, for the promise is unto them of whom the Lord said, 'a remnant should be saved.'

While, therefore, we extend our charity and good feelings unto them, let us not condescend to their level, seek to elevate them in the scale of beings, seek to bring them to a knowledge of their fathers and our fathers, their God and our God, while we thus seek to do them good. It is obvious that we should not place ourselves in their power, subject ourselves to the

caprice of their savage nature which, through causes unknown to us, may at any moment become excited and arrayed against us. Let us then be wise and avoid every measure that gives them any advantage over us. To those brethren who have gone from the Fort and settled south of Cedar City we say, 'return and remain with your brethren.' The settlement of Elk Horn Springs [Enoch] should be maintained as a herd ground, and the brethren at that point should build a fort and be sustained by a few more families, sufficient to strengthen the place against any surprise and, those who dwell there should always be on the alert with their horses and equipments ready at any moment to go or come or defend themselves.

To the brethren at Cedar City we wish to say a few words. We have formed an organization for the purpose of bringing out the iron. It is unnecessary for us to add that this is, and has been, the principal object of locating the settlements in Iron County--you have the ore, the coal, the timber in rich abundance--you have in your midst a supply of grain and need have no fears of a scarcity of food. You will gradually be strengthened in numbers as the emigration shall arrive and everything conspires to accomplish this most desirable object, the manufacture of iron. Brethren, shall it be done, shall the people of this territory be no longer dependent upon foreign and distant countries for their mill, irons, machinery, and stoves, their pots and kettles, their plows and every other useful and necessary implement which is composed of iron, or shall we be disappointed in our expectations and still labor under the present disadvantage of precarious and expensive transportation and continual drain of our money, or do without those articles which are so necessary and which are so easily furnished by a little well-directed industry and perseverance in our midst.

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You have raised your hand in solemn covenant that you will do all that lies in your power to accomplish this object, and we now leave you, with the fullest expectation that you will bend your united and untiring efforts to this purpose with the fullest assurance that but a few weeks shall roll around before the cheering intelligence will salute our ears, 'send your orders, we are prepared to fill them. The iron is piled up in our houses and in our streets, send your teams and carry it away.' You brethren have been selected for this purpose and set apart to this mission. Let no influence swerve you from this duty. Let no selfish interest intervene betwixt you and the accomplishment of your duties, but let a devoted magnanimity for the public interest, blended with a oneness of untiring efforts, characterize all your exertions in whatsoever you shall put yourselves to do, do it in a spirit of oneness and of faith believing, and the happiest results will be most likely to follow, so shall you accomplish the object of your mission and subserve the public good.

How reasonable to suppose that not only our knowledge but our talents, our capacity, be they great or small, should be devoted to the cause of God in whatever calling we may be engaged that is conducive to its interest . . . the work in which you are engaged in the manufacture of iron at this juncture is one branch of the Kingdom of our God and should be pursued with all the vigor and energy that has hitherto characterized your exertions in these valleys--should be pursued as regardless of the consequence pertaining to pecuniary considerations as preaching the gospel. It is as sacred as any other mission, and when was the time and where the place that a faithful elder who trusted in God did not find food and clothing sufficient to supply his necessities? We do not recommend that you neglect to enclose your field, water your grain,

and harvest the same; this is necessary to save and secure the labor which you have performed and the seed which you have put into the ground, but be generous to your mission to intervene and thwart the purpose thereof.

Commence upon a small scale and produce the iron before you go into any great expense, and then you can increase your operations as circumstances will permit and justify. Let your improvements be of a permanent nature that your labor be not lost. Do not be discouraged in your experiments if the first should fail. In new and untried localities that would be an incident most likely to occur and, yet, a subsequent trial prove more successful. But enough has been said upon this subject, words will not accomplish the desired object, but united and persevering efforts will.⁷

During the days that followed the organization of the new L.D.S. Stake Henry wrote:

Thursday, May 13, 1852: Fine morning. Took a walk with Brother Whittaker in the field before breakfast. Had breakfast with Bishop Groves [in Parowan]. Brigham and company started for the Great Salt Lake Valley. I left with Brother Bateman in his wagon, together with Father Whittaker and Peter Shirts, and arrived at Cedar City at ½ past 10 a.m. I called a meeting of the brethren in the evening at Brother Ross's house to attend unto business matters. I submitted the business meetings into the hands of the bishop, Brother Smith. I addressed the brethren on being united and urged them to enclose the field and finish the water ditches as a work to be done preparatory to commencing the iron business. I inquired of the brethren if they were willing to sustain and uphold me by their faith and prayers and abide by

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my counsels. Every person manifested that they wanted to by raising their right hand. Bishop Smith chose Brother Hulse and Father Whittaker for his Counselors over the Cedar City Ward and ordained them.

Sunday, May 16, 1852: Morning's meeting commenced at 11 o'clock. There was a very good attendance, and an excellent spirit prevailed. The choir sang most beautifully. For the first time they sang their music with an accompaniment which consisted of an ophicleide, clarinet, and flute.

I instructed the brethren to be punctual in their meetings and that, in the future, two signals would be given at ½ past 10 for the people to prepare, and another at 5 minutes to 11, and the meeting to commence precisely at 11 o'clock. And, again, the horn would be sounded at 10 minutes before two, and the meeting to commence precisely at two. I instructed the brethren to suspend with watering on the sabbath day as we had abundance of water and, not only so, but I did not like for to see saints work on Sundays.⁸

The settlers participated in a general cattle drive on Monday, May 17, for the purpose of sending the spare cattle to Johnson Springs. Henry sent a yearling calf, branded with an "L" on the right horn. President Calvin Smith called a meeting of the High Council at Henry Lunt's house on Sunday, May 23, after the general meeting. He informed the Council that he had received instructions from President George A. Smith to organize the High Councillors in Parowan and Cedar City into a quorum. Henry Lunt was the head of the quorum in Cedar City. John Steele wrote in his journal: "Henry Lunt was sent to preside in Cedar City, and for me to remain and help Calvin in Parowan."⁹

Lunt assembled the High Council on Monday evening, May 24, but decided it was too late to conduct any business. He said, "I do

not agree with night meetings, there are plenty of days for us to do business without turning night into day. When night comes, the body is fatigued and needs rest. We have a great deal to overcome in this place, and we have need to be on our guard all the time." The High Council came together again at Brother Whittaker's house the next morning at 8 a.m. Henry wrote the following about the counsel he gave them and the events of the next few days:

I want this quorum to be united and feel a oneness of spirit, for it is impossible for us to do any good in any business that we do transact unless we are one. The reason I say this is because I feel that there are hard feelings existing between brethren in this Council at the present time, and it is in consequence of Brother Carruthers ploughing with two teams right in opposition to counsel given on Sunday by the Presidency, not only thereby breaking counsel, but setting a bad example to the whole of the brethren, in consequence of which this Council cannot feel well towards Brother Carruthers in so doing.

Considerable was said to Brother Carruthers by the Council, and finally he humbled himself and said he was very glad that he did not leave us, which he had debated doing, for he now felt good and was willing to be one of us and took each of the brethren by the hand and asked forgiveness and said that he was on hand to do whatever I required of him and that he had a good knowledge of the iron and coal business. It caused my heart to rejoice. I urged the fence round the big field to be completed so as the Iron Company could commence on the Iron Works. The people generally appeared to be selfish and disunited. I felt that the powers of the evil one were strongly against me and my Council. The meeting dispersed and I retired to my wagon and went to pray before the Lord.

Wednesday, May 26, 1852: Very hot day.

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Thunder on the mountains and the creek still rising. I looked around today to see what all the brethren in camp were doing. I found them all very busy, some ploughing, some planting seeds, some building houses, and but three putting up fence. I just felt that the Devil had had his way long enough over this mission, and I was determined, by the help of the Lord, to stop it and start the Iron Works, the mission for which this person was sent to this place for.

Saturday, May 28: I called the Foot Company together in the center of the Fort and told them the best thing for them to do would be to put up the fence. The cattle are destroying the crops in a shameful manner. Some were opposed to this counsel and insulted me by saying they just should not do it. I gave them a good preach on the importance of obeying counsel and put the whole company under Marshall Law. They went to work at the fence and finished putting it all up by 4 p.m.¹⁰

The following article appeared in the *Deseret News* on May 29, 1852:

Report of the visit of President Young and Kimball to Cedar City in May 1852: But little has been done at Coal Creek towards the manufacture of iron; though their dwelling houses, gardens, corrals, etc., are now completed and the settlement is newly organized into an iron manufacturing company who, it is expected, will prosecute the business without delay. Brethren, we want a large quantity of mill gearing and stoves, cooking utensils, and railroad fixings before another winter. We are informed that the entire settlement of ironmongers is composed of Englishmen, except two Yankees, one of whom is a Dutchman, and the other an Irishman. If such a company cannot blow iron, who can? We hope for a

more full report from this expedition at a future day, although the party did not go over the rim of the Basin or extend their research to a very great extent beyond that of last season. One of the greatest evils we have heard reported is the neglect of the citizens in not providing themselves with suitable forts. Should Indians come upon them as they are, they would remember the counsel they have forgotten by bitter experience.

Lunt was called to preach in the morning meeting on Sunday, May 30. He spent an hour talking on the subject of oneness. Obviously there were some problems in the High Council primarily due to the fact that Matthew Carruthers had been Presiding Elder over Cedar City and, when Henry Lunt was put in the Stake Presidency, it superseded that calling. On Monday, May 31, Henry wrote: "The Council sat until 12 o'clock night, and Brother Carruthers did not see things as I, and the rest of the Council did." That day they received instructions to hold a fast on the first Thursday of each month, also to take what scrap iron they needed for building machinery off their own wagons. The following day Brother Carruthers did not come to the evening meeting. In the prayer they asked the Lord to help them so that the way before them would be opened to find stone coal.

During the Council meeting the evening of Sunday, June 6, the case of Betsy Pugmire and Brother Bosnell, both being present, was brought before the group. Lunt wrote about this event: "Betsy Pugmire had been living with Brother Bosnell and had now left him, and she was slandering his character. The girl acknowledged her sins and admitted that what she had been reporting was entirely untrue. She was instructed to repent and get rebaptized and she was forgiven." A week later, Jesse Lewis came to visit Henry Lunt and said he wanted to marry Betsy (Elizabeth) Pugmire. Henry said, "As it is both of your desires for to be married, you had better be married, and you better go to Brother Pugmire, Betsy's father, and tell him your business in an upright straightforward manner, and I do not doubt but what all things will be made agreeable." Later Brother

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Pugmire told Henry that he believed that Brother Bosnell was guilty of the things his daughter accused him of, and he had found evidence to prove it. They agreed to make further inquiry. Jesse Lewis and Betsy Pugmire were married by Henry Lunt on June 13.

A meeting was called in the center of the Fort early on June 7. Henry instructed the men that those who felt like spending all their time in the iron works should be free from the field, and those who were farmers, and would like to spend all their time in farming, should be united in taking care of the field. The men who chose to work in the Iron Works were counseled to let out their crops to those who would take charge of the field, and they were to give them one-half of their grain which would pay them well. Henry said, "If there are men here who will not comply with these requisitions, they had better gather up and leave this place." After this dissertation, sixteen men turned out for the iron business. Some went to digging out a place for the wheel to blow the blast furnace, and some went to the canyon for timber.

Nearly all the folks in town went off in wagons to Elk Horn Springs to hold a picnic party on Monday, June 21, 1852. There were very few left in camp. That day, Henry wrote in his journal: "About 11 a.m. ten Indians came to our house and seemed rather saucy. I gave them a smoke and a piece of bread each. They then went round to the other's houses. Sister Bladen gave them some bread and they threw it to the ground." After the picnic a dance was held at Chatterley's house. The next day Alex Easton's mare was found shot with an arrow and subsequently died.

George Brimhall and Brother Gould came in from Shirt's Canyon on June 27 for Sunday meeting. They had gone to the canyon to get hearth stones, and, while there, some Indians brought a beautiful specimen of stone isinglass and said there was any quantity of it two sleeps off--large rocks of it as big as a house. Brimhall and Gould brought the specimen to the meeting with them. It was agreed that the isinglass would make beautiful window glass. Lunt and Brimhall addressed the congregation. Later, Henry recorded: "I am thankful to my Heavenly Father for making known unto us the hidden treasures of the mountains that are so useful unto his Saints."¹¹ That evening

Henry sent an article to the *Deseret News* which was published nearly a month later on July 24. The following is the article:

We have been very busily engaged in preparing to make iron for the last month. Considerable work has been done. The fire brick for the furnace are ready for laying up and prove to be of the very best quality. The timber which we needed for the framing of the machinery, we hauled from a canyon five miles south of Coal Creek where there is an abundance of beautiful pine timber and any quantity of poles for fencing. A few hands went with teams and worked the road one day and hauled loads back to the Iron Works the following day. There is a good extensive blacksmith's shop erected, and the iron work for the machinery is progressing rapidly. It requires a deal of iron for the works which we principally obtain off our wagons--take the tire off and lay the wood work to one side until we can replace it with the iron from the Works. Our faith is that, in a very few weeks, we shall see iron of our own manufacture.

A number of the brethren from Parowan and this place have been working out their taxes in making a road up Coal Creek Canyon during the past week. The road is made within one mile of the coal--the distance from the Iron Works to the coal is supposed to be about eight miles. The coal that was discovered in the mountain east of the Fort during the time Brother Brigham was here has been examined and proves to be of no benefit.

The water ditch that supplies the upper part of our field has been very troublesome owing to it washing in some places so tremendously, and again filling other places up with sand that has washed over the sides. A great amount of labor has been spent over it and it is now doing much better. The crops in

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general look first rate. I have a piece of barley nearly ready to harvest.

The following persons are leaving this place contrary to counsel: Daniel and Alexander Ross and Evan Evans and family.

There is a good spirit in our midst--no sickness, and at peace with the Lamanites. Yours in the Gospel Covenant, Henry Lunt

It thundered and rained on Monday, June 28. Henry wrote: "Labored late in the evening at hoeing potatoes for I have no other time but nights and mornings for to do my own chores. Moved into Brother Wiley's house until mine is built." Henry's father-in-law, James Whittaker, was doing most of the watering of the wheat and the garden, belonging to Henry and Ellen, while Henry worked in the Iron Works.

The following day Henry recorded that he labored at blacksmithing and made a very heavy gudgeon for the water wheel at the Iron Works. Henry and Supt. Harrison went to visit Matthew Carruthers who was in bed with a lame foot. They asked him for some iron for the Iron Works, as he had two wagons and lots of old iron. Apparently, he had promised them one of his wagons and the old iron during one of the Council meetings, but he now said that he had no iron to spare and he thought he should leave and return to the Great Salt Lake Valley. Because they needed the iron immediately, Henry took the tire off his new wagon, the only one he had, and appropriated it to the Iron Works. He wrote: "May the Lord grant that I may at all times be willing to part with anything that he has placed in my possession for the building up of his Kingdom."

Several days before, some of the men had expressed their dissatisfaction with Brother Harrison's proceedings. A meeting was held to discuss this and Henry advised them to be diligent and faithful in their mission and be humble and united. He told them that it was not the place of anyone to find fault with another man's work. They seemed to settle the matter for the present.

John White, who had traveled to Salt Lake City to get his family,

arrived in Cedar City on July 1st with his wife and children. While traveling, the Indians stole a cow and two calves from him and wounded two others. Since he and his family made the trip alone, Henry stated: "A very thoughtless foolish piece of business for one man to come alone. He will learn better another time--very well it was no worse with him."

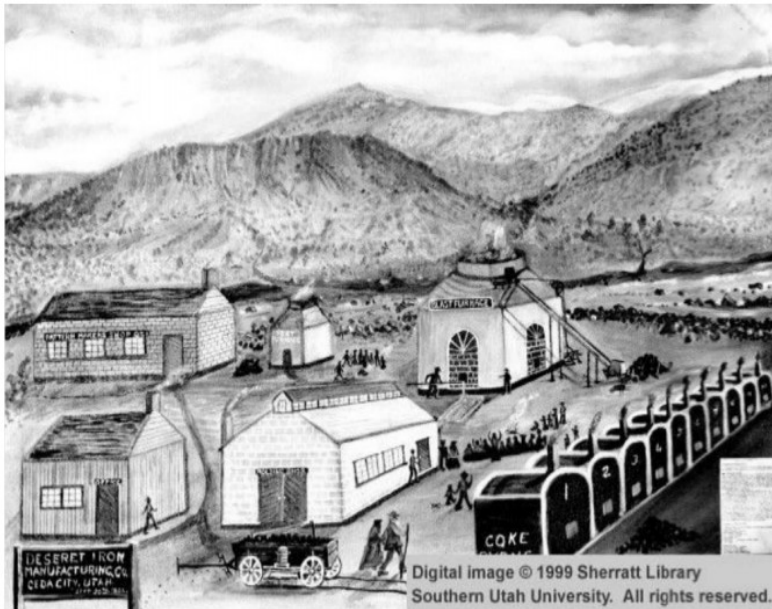
Henry's journal entry on July 8, 1852 follows:

Fine day, very warm. Labored at the Iron Works hauling rock in the forenoon, and in the afternoon sawing with a whip saw. Traded my wagon to Brother Adshead for 4000 adobes, payable in one month. Took a walk in the evening with Brother Whittaker and his wife and my wife in the field. My heart was made to rejoice in seeing my wheat look so well. Truly said I, 'The Lord hath blessed my crops and the labor by my hands. Praise be His holy name.' The crops in general look much better than those at Parowan did last year. The water ditches do not wash so much now and everything seems to go on more prosperous since the Iron Works have been commenced. It shows that when saints do what they were sent to do, the Lord prospers them and the labor of their hands.

1. Andrew Jenson, *L.D.S. Journal History*, Entry for May 8, 1852.
2. Henry Lunt, "Henry Lunt Journal," (Provo, Utah: B.Y.U. Library, copied from original journal 1955) p. 62.
3. *Ibid.*, p. 63.
4. *L.D.S. Biographical Encyclopedia*, (Salt Lake City, Utah) page 532.
5. Henry Lunt, *op.cit.*, p. 63.
6. Andrew Jenson, *Encyclopedic History of The L.D.S. Church*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Deseret News Publishing Co., 1941).
7. Andrew Jenson, *op. cit.*, Letter from Brigham Young and Heber C. Kimball to Iron County Stake, Parowan, Utah, May 12, 1852, Found in L.D.S. Church History division, Salt Lake City, Utah, L.D.S. Film 6778.

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8. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 64.
9. Extracts from John Steel's Journal, *The Utah Historical Quarterly*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Utah Historical Society).
10. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 72.
11. *Ibid.*, p. 79.



PAINTING OF IRON WORKS

Cedar City, Utah

Painted by R. D. Adams

Adams took his grandfather, Barclay Adams, an official at the Deseret Iron Company, to this spot on the banks of Coal Creek, First East and Fourth North.

With his grandfather's help, Adams painted this picture.